

Everyone wants to have a **great smile** that is why good oral hygiene is important! Having poor oral hygiene can lead to a variety of dental and medical problems in the future such as gum disease, infection, bone loss, heart disease, strokes and more. Regular checkups and cleanings can prevent these problems as well as provides with good oral hygiene.

5.3.4 Purposes of Oral Hygiene.

1) Helps maintain the healthy state of the mouth, teeth, gums and lips.
2) Brushing cleanses the teeth of food articles, plaque and bacteria.
3) Brushing massages the gums.
4) Brushing relieves discomfort resulting from unpleasant odours and tastes.
5) Oral hygiene gives a sense of well being.
6) Proper oral hygiene stimulates appetite.
7) It improves taste.

5.3.5 Measures to maintain Proper Oral Hygiene.

1) Cleanliness, comfort, and moisturizing the mouth structures prevents oral disease and tooth destruction.
2) Brushing, flossing and irrigation are necessary for proper cleansing.
3) To prevent tooth decay, reduce the intake of carbohydrates, especially sweet snacks between meals.
4) Brushing the teeth at least ***two times a day*** is basic to an effective oral hygiene. (after meals and at bed time)
5) Tooth brushes should be replaced every ***three months***.
6) After brushing,thorough rinsing is important to remove dislodged food particles.
7) Flossing helps remove plaque and tartar from between teeth to reduce the gum inflammation and infection.
8) Going for regular dental checkup is important.
9) Most dental professionals agree that a ***soft-bristled brush*** is best for removing plaque and debris from your teeth.
10) ***Salt water*** is a good mouth wash solution. It is made by dissolving 1–0.5 teaspoon of table salt into a cup of hot water and rinsing the mouth. Saline has a mechanical cleansing action and an antiseptic action as it is a hypertonic solution in relation to bacteria, which undergo lysis.

5.3.6 Food and Fluids maintain proper oral hygiene.

1. ***Vitamin C*** is needed for healthy gums, to prevent scurvy. (Gum disease.)
2. Eating a balanced diet and limiting snacks can help prevent tooth decay and periodontal disease.
3. Raw vegetables, plain yogurt, or fruit are beneficial.

Nursing-voc_Unit 05.indd 136 22-02-2019 4.45.23 PM